



## MINNEHAHA UNITED METHODIST CHURCH

*A Reconciling Congregation*  
WE SEEK. WE SERVE. WE CELEBRATE



September 12, 2021

### *Welcome Friends!*

We welcome you to worship wherever you may be in your faith's journey. We strive to live in the way of Jesus Christ, sharing God's love on a daily basis regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history.

We livestream our worship services, and you may end up in view of the camera at any point in the service.

*We ask you to refrain from playing on the playground during worship; you are welcome to use it after worship (as long as you are small enough to fit on the equipment!)*

**\* Please rise in body or spirit**

## Gathering Music

*Ripple*

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## Greeting

### \*Call to Worship

*(adapted from Flames of the Spirit, ed. Ruth C. Duck)*

Leader: The God of New Beginnings has called us to this place.

**People: We come celebrating the new life that is ours as God's faithful people.**

Leader: Let your joy ring through the universe, and let your vision see to the depths of every soul.

**People: We will be shouters of joy and seekers of God's light wherever we go.  
Praise God for this day!**

### \*Hymn

*The Summons*

*The Faith We Sing* #2130

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Will you come and follow me if I but call your name?  
Will you go where you don't know and never be the same?  
Will you let my love be shown? Will you let my name be known,  
will you let my life be grown in you and you in me?

Will you leave yourself behind if I but call your name?  
Will you care for cruel and kind and never be the same?  
Will you risk the hostile stare should your life attract or scare?  
Will you let me answer prayer in you and you in me?

Will you let the blinded see if I but call your name?  
Will you set the prisoners free and never be the same?  
Will you kiss the leper clean and do such as this unseen,  
and admit to what I mean in you and you in me?

Will you love the "you" you hide if I but call your name?  
Will you quell the fear inside and never be the same?  
Will you use the faith you've found to reshape the world around,  
through my sight and touch and sound in you and you in me?

Lord your summons echoes true when you but call my name.  
Let me turn and follow you and never be the same.  
In your company I'll go where your love and footsteps show.  
Thus I'll move and live and grow in you and you in me.

## Children's Message

Jenia Strom

## Baptism

Vows for parents and sponsors

Congregational Vow:

**With God's help we will proclaim the good news and live according to the example of Christ. We will surround this child with a community of love and forgiveness, that she may grow in her service to others. We will pray for her, that she may be a true disciple who walks in the ways that lead to life.**

Blessing over the water

Baptism of Amelia Mary Kelley

Introduction to the Congregation

Congregational Response:

**We welcome Amelia Mary joyfully and reverently as a member of our family, the family of God. We offer ourselves to be siblings, aunts and uncles, and grandparents in Christ. We accept our sacred responsibility to help her grow in faith and in God's love. Send your blessing and your peace upon this family, that their love for one another and for you may grow. Help us to see your image in this child so that we may also learn from her what life is about.**

## Passing the Peace

## Prayers

### Sharing of Joys & Concerns

### Morning Prayer

*(adapted from Flames of the Spirit, ed. Ruth C. Duck)*

**O God, our God, we confess that we have not always lived for you. You have invited us into new life, yet we have closed our eyes and ears and hearts against that invitation. You have shown us the way to love, yet we have chosen too often the path of uncaring. You have called us to the ministry of reconciliation, yet often we find ourselves tempted to turn away from others. You have challenged us to generosity, but many times we would rather keep to ourselves. Enter our lives, God, once again. Release us from the bonds of self-centeredness. Create in us a renewed openness to your love, that we may share your love with others. *Amen.***

### Silent Prayers

### Pastoral Prayer

## **The Lord's Prayer**

*inclusive*

**Our Creator, God in heaven,  
hallowed be thy name.  
Thy kin-dom<sup>✱</sup> come, thy will be done,  
on earth as it is in heaven.  
Give us this day our daily bread.  
And forgive us our trespasses as we forgive  
those who trespass against us.  
Lead us not into temptation,  
but deliver us from evil.  
For thine is the kin-dom and the power  
and the glory forever. *Amen.***

<sup>✱</sup>*Kin-dom represents a hope for God's realm where we are all in community with one another.*

## **Scripture Reading**

**James 3:1-12**  
John Darlington

## **\*Hymn**

*The United Methodist Hymnal #408*

## ***The Gift of Love***

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Though I may speak with bravest fire,  
and have the gift to all inspire,  
and have not love, my words are vain,  
as sounding brass, and hopeless gain.

Though I may give all I possess,  
and striving so my love profess,  
but not be given by love within,  
the profit soon turns strangely thin.

Come, Spirit, come, our hearts control,  
our spirits long to be made whole.  
Let inward love guide every deed;  
by this we worship, and are freed.

## **Message**

**“Sticks and Stones May Break My Bones, But Words . . .”**  
Rev. Becky Sechrist

## **Offertory**

## ***Stay (I Missed You)***

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## **Prayer of Dedication**

**As we share our bread with the poor, open our ears and hearts to learn from them to live  
by faith, not sight. Free us from our tendency to be possessive and protective, that we may  
experience the freedom and joy of giving. May faith and works together fill our lives with  
meaning and purpose. *Amen.***

## Blessing for Children, Youth, and Teachers

(adapted from a blessing written by Reverend Shari Prestemon  
on September 7, 2021)

God of Wisdom, God of abiding care, as a new school year begins, watch over all of us.

Give students of every age a deep well of curiosity and the simple delights of seeing friends and learning new lessons.

Give teachers and professors a rekindled love of their vocation, an abiding patience with their students and themselves.

To principals and school boards and college presidents and all administration, lend deep wisdom and steady decision-making amidst so much anxiety and hurt in these ongoing days of COVID.

To all who keep the schools clean and cook the students' meals and labor behind the scenes to make the school year a positive and seamless one, offer your blessing.

To parents of school children everywhere, and parents who are going back to school themselves, give a measure of peace, a chance to breathe deeply, and resilience for the journey.

For our own programs, for those who lead, those who show up, those children, youth and adults who come together to learn and care for one another, give a sense of your presence in encounters with the Bible and with each other.

Cover all of these with a blanket of grace and strength. May joy overwhelm worry, and good health outdo harm.

We pray it all in the name of Jesus, whose own ministry was a classroom, whose pupils still today learn of love and mercy and justice. *Amen.*

## Benediction

## Traveling Music

## Country Roads

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### Worship Personnel

Rev. Becky Sechrist, *Pastor*;  
Jenia Strom, *Program Director of Children, Youth, and Families*  
Alex Rack, *Choir Director*; Anders Nelson, *Organist*;  
Tim Siefkes and Josh Espinosa, *Contemporary Band Leaders*;  
Nicholas and Patience Sabah, *Communion Stewards*

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*We are delighted you are here! And, to minimize the handing around of things, we invite you to "sign the welcome pad" electronically. If you point your camera phone at the QR code below, it will take you to a google form where you can enter your information. If you don't have a camera phone, there are sign in sheets at the tables where you found bulletins.*



*For our offering, there are buckets for your cash or check offerings on the tables where you picked up your bulletin. You can also give electronically with the Give Plus app, through the PayPal account online, or by using this QR Code (which takes you to our PayPal account).*

MUMC DONATION



## Announcements

### Holding in prayer:

- **Transitional Care:** Alice Streed after being hospitalized for a stroke.
- **Anticipating Surgery:** Sybylla Yeoman Hendrix for the removal of an ovarian cyst.
- **Hospice:** Joan Ellison, Eric Schlensker
- **Receiving treatment for cancer:** Sigrid Skaaland, Carol Spearman, Kate Stower

**Worship in September:** Worship in September will look a lot like it does now! We will continue with one worship service, outside, at 10:00. If it is raining, then we will move inside to the sanctuary and ask that you wear a mask. Our goal is to return to 2 worship services in October, but stay tuned!

**Masks required inside:** We are amending our mask policy by requiring everyone to wear masks in our common areas in the building (this includes the sanctuary, narthex, fellowship hall, kitchen, bathrooms, etc.). Small groups that are meeting behind closed doors may still choose to make masks optional for the duration of their gathering.

**Adult Zoom Class on Beliefs:** This fall, there will be a class held on zoom on Monday nights that explores what we do, and don't, believe. Based on the book *What's the Least I Can Believe and Still Be a Christian* by Martin Thielen, we'll spend 5 weeks looking at the things we don't believe, and 5 weeks looking at things we do believe, with a final week to wrap it all up. Classes start on Sept. 13 and end on November 29. If you are interested, please buy the book and read chapters 1 & 2 prior to Sept. 13. Please also contact Becky for the zoom link to the class.

**Adult In Person Class on Rules:** We are spending a lot of time in our country determining, debating, and defying the various rules that help us be community. In the midst of this national conversation (confrontation), you are invited to take a step back in time and study the rules that guided the early Hebrew community. We'll gather on Tuesday afternoons at 2:00 from September 14 through October 12 in person at the church, and there will also be an online option. If you are interested in joining through zoom, please let Becky know prior to September 14 so she can get the technology set up appropriately. The first class will be introductory, with your reading assignments for each week coming after that.